36.

STRANGE, AFTER so much mourning, to just…*party*. But months later came the Golden Jubilee. Fiftieth anniversary of Granny's reign.

Over four days that summer of 2002, Willy and I were constantly pulling on another set of smart clothes, jumping into another black car, rushing to yet another venue for another party or parade, reception or gala.

Britain was intoxicated. People did jigs in the streets, sang from balconies and rooftops. Everyone wore some version of the Union Jack. In a nation known for its reticence, this was a startling expression of unbridled joy.

Startling to me anyway. Granny didn't seem startled. I was startled at how unstartled she was. It wasn't that she felt no emotions. On the contrary, I always thought that Granny experienced all the normal human emotions. She just knew better than the rest of us mortals how to control them.

I stood beside or behind her through much of the Golden Jubilee Weekend and I often thought: If this can't shake her then she's truly earned her reputation for imperturbable serenity. In which case, I thought, maybe I'm a foundling? Because I'm a nervous wreck.

There were several reasons for my nerves, but the main one was a brewing scandal. Just before the Jubilee I'd been summoned by one of the courtiers to his little office and without much buildup he'd asked: *Harry—are you doing cocaine?*

Shades of my lunch with Marko.

What? Am I—? How could—? No!

Hm. Well. Could there be a photo out there? Is it possible that someone somewhere might have a photo of you doing cocaine?

God, no! That's ridiculous! Why?

He explained that he'd been approached by a newspaper editor who claimed to have come into possession of a photo showing Prince Harry snorting a line.

He's a liar. It's not true.

I see. Be that as it may, this editor is willing to lock the photo into his safe forever. But in exchange he wants to sit down with you and explain that what you're doing is very damaging. He wants to give you some life advice.

Ah. Creepy. And devious. Diabolical, in fact, because if I agree to this meeting, then I'm admitting guilt.

Right.